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PDF GUIDE · PROGRAM GUIDE

HOW THE PROGRAM WORKS.

Everything you need to know before your first session. How the program runs, how to build your week and how to get the most out of the next twelve weeks.

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01 · HOW THE PROGRAM WORKS

WE WRITE THE PLAN. YOU PUT IN THE WORK.

STR2G HYROX 12 Weeks Race Prep is a twelve-week build to your HYROX race. No random WODs. Every week has a job and builds on the one before.

The program gives you structure, paces, technique and support. The result comes from what happens between Monday and Sunday. We've seen average athletes stay consistent for 12 weeks and surprise themselves on race day. We've also seen talented people train "when they felt like it" and fall apart on the wall balls in round seven. Consistency beats talent almost every time.

WHAT	WHAT IT IS	WHEN AND WHERE
Weekly programming	2 run sessions + 2 strength / HYROX sessions, paces and equipment options	Every Monday for the full week, in the training app
Pace zones	Your personal run paces, based on your 1 km test	After the test in week 1
3 workshops	Kick-off and baseline testing, mid-program check, final testing	Weeks 1, 6 and 12
Education library	Videos on technique, running, strength, mobility and racing	In the app, unlocks step by step
5 PDF guides	Program guide, nutrition, warm-up, mobility, race day	Released during the program
WhatsApp community	Private group, daily tips, sharing, coach answers	All 12 weeks, coaches reply twice a day

PROGRAMMING VS. COACHED CLASSES

PROGRAMMING = THE CORE

Four sessions a week in the app, built on your paces and on the phase you're in. You do them on your own schedule, in the gym or outside. This is what gets you race-ready. Equipment options cover you if your gym has no sled or SkiErg.

CLASSES = THE BONUS

Coached HYROX classes at Form Factory are **not included in the program price**. You cover them with your own membership or drop-ins. We recommend them: group energy, a coach watching, real kit. But the program works without them.

Why split it like this? Everyone's schedule is different. Some people can make three classes a week, others work shifts and train at 6 a.m. The programming has to work for both. Classes are an extra layer, not a replacement.

WHAT WE EXPECT FROM YOU

- [ ] On Monday you read the whole week and put the sessions in your calendar.
- [ ] You run at the paces we give you. Not faster.
- [ ] You warm up before every session, using the Warm-up Protocol.
- [ ] You log every session: numbers, RPE, one line of notes.
- [ ] You show up to all three workshops.
- [ ] If something hurts, doesn't fit or you're falling behind, you tell us straight away. Not three weeks later.

GOLDEN RULE

Do what's on the plan. Not more, not faster, not heavier. The sessions are designed to stack. Every "I'll just add a bit extra" comes out of tomorrow's session.

02 · YOUR WEEK

A GOOD WEEK IS BUILT ON MONDAY.

How you lay out your four sessions decides whether you show up to your key run fresh, or with legs like concrete.

To keep things simple, this guide calls the sessions the following. The exact content changes with each phase; the logic doesn't.

SESSION	WHAT IT IS	LOAD
Run A – quality	Intervals, tempo, race pace	High. Needs fresh legs.
Run B – volume	Longer aerobic run at low intensity	Low intensity, longer duration
Strength / HYROX 1	Strength block + shorter HYROX piece	High on muscles, mostly legs
Strength / HYROX 2	Hybrid workout: running + stations, transitions	High metabolic load

RULES FOR BUILDING YOUR WEEK

01 **Never Run A the day after heavy legs.** After sleds, lunges or heavy squats you won't hit the paces. You'll just learn to run slow at full effort.

02 **Ideally 48 hours between hard sessions,** 24 at the very least, with a good night's sleep.

03 **Back-to-back hard days once a week, max.** Follow them with a rest or easy day.

04 **At least one full rest day.** Walking and mobility yes, training no.

05 **Run B is fine after a strength day.** Easy running on tired legs is good race prep.

06 **A coached class counts as a hard day.** It's not a "light extra".

SAMPLE WEEKS

DAY	4 DAYS	5 DAYS (+1 CLASS)	6 DAYS (+1 CLASS, +1 EASY)
Mon	Run A	Run A	Run A

DAY	4 DAYS	5 DAYS (+1 CLASS)	6 DAYS (+1 CLASS, +1 EASY)
Tue	Strength / HYROX 1	Strength / HYROX 1	Strength / HYROX 1
Wed	Rest	Run B	Run B
Thu	Strength / HYROX 2	Rest	Class at FF
Fri	Rest	Class at FF	Rest (non-negotiable)
Sat	Run B	Strength / HYROX 2	Strength / HYROX 2
Sun	Rest	Rest	Z1–Z2 run 30 min or mobility

4 days suits a full work week, family life and beginners. It's plenty. **5 days** is, in our view, the best balance of load and recovery. **6 days** is for experienced athletes with at least a year of consistent training and solid sleep. The sixth day is always easy; a second hard class won't fit. If you miss your Run A paces for two weeks on this setup, drop back to five.

SHORT ON TIME: WHAT TO CUT

ORDER	WHAT YOU DO	WHY
1	Drop the coached class	It's the bonus. Programming comes first.
2	Cut Run B to 25–30 min	You keep the aerobic stimulus and pick up the volume later.
3	Strength / HYROX 1: main block only	The main lift does most of the work.
4	Protect Run A and Strength / HYROX 2	Most race-specific. If you only have time for two sessions, do these.

MISSED SESSIONS AND MOVING DAYS

- **Missed one session? Let it go.** One out of 48 won't decide anything. Carry on with the plan.
- **Never cram two sessions into one day** or stack three hard days in a row. Three sessions done well beat five done badly.
- **Moving days is fine.** The plan cares about order and spacing, not specific weekdays. The check: will I have fresh legs for Run A, and is there enough time between hard sessions?
- **Don't drag sessions into the next week.** The new plan starts on Monday.
- **Lost a whole week?** Message us. We'll tell you whether to pick up where you are or repeat part of the previous week.

03 · BASELINE TEST AND PACE ZONES

NO TEST, NO DIRECTION. JUST GUESSING.

Every run pace in the program comes from one number: your 1 km time. Rush the test and your paces will be off for all 12 weeks.

The baseline test is a 1 km time trial. As fast as you can, but evenly paced. Your coaches use the time to set your personal pace zones. We run the test at Workshop 1 and you repeat the same test at Workshop 3. The difference is the most honest measure of what the program did. Can't make the workshop? Do it on your own using the protocol below and send us the result.

PROTOCOL

01 **10–15 min easy jog,** building to conversational pace.

02 **5 min mobility** from the Warm-up Protocol: hips, ankles, thoracic spine.

03 **3–4 min running drills:** A-skips, high knees, butt kicks.

04 **3–4 strides of 80–100 m,** building speed, walk back.

05 **2–3 min break:** walk, drink, set up your watch.

06 **1 km all-out, evenly paced.**

07 **10 min very easy cool-down.**

PACING THE TEST

The classic mistake is going out like it's a sprint. The first 200 m feel easy, it hits you at 500 m, and the second half is 20 seconds slower. That time doesn't reflect what you can actually do.

- **0–300 m:** fast but controlled. You should feel you could go quicker.
- **300–700 m:** hold the pace. This is where it starts to hurt and where the test is decided.
- **700–1000 m:** push, and give everything over the last 200 m.

CONDITIONS

- [ ] Flat surface, ideally a track (2.5 laps of a 400 m track)
- [ ] No hard leg session the day before

- [ ] Eat 2–3 hours before, nothing new. Wear the shoes you normally run in.
- [ ] Note your time, splits, heart rate, surface and weather. Do the final test in the same spot.

READING YOUR ZONES

We set your exact paces from your test. Here's how each zone should feel.

ZONE	FEEL AND RPE	BREATHING	WHAT IT'S FOR
Z1 Recovery	Very easy, RPE 2–3	Full sentences, nose breathing	Cool-downs, warm-ups, recovery
Z2 Aerobic base	Easy, RPE 3–4, could go for an hour+	Full sentences	Run B, the base of everything
Z3 Tempo	Comfortably uncomfortable, RPE 5–6	Short sentences	Tempo efforts, running economy
Z4 Threshold	Hard, RPE 7–8, needs focus	A few words	Intervals, raising the pace you can hold
Z5 VO2max	Very hard, RPE 9–10	No talking	Short intervals, max aerobic power

Race pace is its own number. On race day you never run a fresh kilometre; you run it after sleds or lunges. That's why it's slower than your test pace, and we train it mainly in hybrid workouts.

GOLDEN RULE OF ZONES

Run your easy runs truly easy. For most people we coach, the problem isn't running hard sessions too slowly. It's running easy sessions too fast and having nothing left for the hard ones. Z2 should feel boring. That's the point.

TREADMILL, OUTDOORS, HR AND FEEL

- **Treadmill:** set a 1% incline. Great for intervals, but the speed readout isn't always accurate. Do at least some runs off the treadmill; you won't race on one.
- **Outdoors:** on hills and into the wind, run by effort, not pace. GPS gets confused between buildings and under trees. Find flat ground for Run A.
- **Pace** is the main metric for Run A. **Heart rate** is useful for Run B. If it drifts up at Z2 pace, that's fatigue, heat or something coming on. It lags behind on short intervals. A chest strap beats a wrist sensor.
- **Feel (RPE)** is your cross-check. When pace, heart rate and feel disagree, go with feel and slow down. Never the other way round.

04 · 12 WEEKS, STEP BY STEP

EVERY WEEK HAS A PURPOSE.

Three phases: Base, Performance, Race. Know where you are and you'll know why you feel the way you do.

WEEK	FOCUS	WHAT HAPPENS
PHASE 1 · BASE		
01	Adaptation	Kick-off, baseline testing, finding your rhythm
02	Foundation	Building the base, station technique
03	Technique	Refining technique, more volume
04	Volume	Longer sessions, aerobic capacity
PHASE 2 · PERFORMANCE		
05	Intensity	HR zones, VO2max
06	Deload	Recovery + Workshop 2
07	Specific	Race pace, hybrid workouts
08	Simulation	HYROX simulation, 6 stations
09	Peak week	Highest intensity
PHASE 3 · RACE		
10	Tapering	Lower volume, stay sharp
11	Race week	Activation, race prep
12	Finale	Workshop 3, final testing

BASE · WEEKS 1–4

What to expect: testing, setting paces, lots of station technique. Volume builds gradually; week 4 is the longest of the phase. **How you'll feel:** the first two weeks might feel like "not enough". Most people are surprised how slow Z2 is. Around weeks 3–4 the first volume fatigue shows up. **Focus on:** four sessions a week with no gaps, discipline on easy runs, technique on all 8 stations (film your wall balls and burpee broad jumps) and building the logging habit.

PERFORMANCE · WEEKS 5–9

What to expect: week 5 brings the first properly hard intervals. Week 6 is a deload with Workshop 2. From week 7 you train what decides the race: race pace, running on tired legs, transitions. Week 8 is a 6-station simulation, week 9 the toughest week of the program. **How you'll feel:** during the deload you may feel like you're losing fitness. You're not; your body is absorbing the work. The simulation will show you exactly where you'll break on race day. By the end of week 9 you'll be tired. That's the plan. **Focus on:** doing the deload as a deload, pacing (your first run should never be your fastest), transitions with no standing around, sleep and food. Log your splits from the simulation.

RACE · WEEKS 10–12

What to expect: volume drops, intensity stays in shorter doses. Race week is about activation and logistics. Week 12 brings Workshop 3 and final testing. **How you'll feel:** the taper is weird. Fresh, lazy and nervous all at once. Little niggles appear that weren't there before. Your body is recovering and your head is looking for something to worry about. **Focus on:** not chasing fitness (what you didn't build by week 9, you won't build now), your race plan for paces and stations, logistics from the Race Day + Checklists guide, and a mental plan for the tough moments.

GOLDEN RULE OF PHASES

In Base, success is getting everything done calmly. In Performance, it's handling the hard work and recovering. In Race, it's turning up to the start line fresh. Don't judge week 2 by how you felt in week 9.

05 · WORKSHOPS, APP AND RESOURCES

EVERYTHING IN ONE PLACE.

Sessions, videos and guides live in the app. The workshops are three checkpoints where we meet in person and measure where you are.

WORKSHOP	WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS
W1 Kick-off + baseline testing	Week 1	Program intro, 1 km test, station technique, goal setting
W2 Mid-program check	Week 6	Progress check, technique and pacing fixes, adjusting goals
W3 Final testing + review	Week 12	Final test, comparison with baseline, review, what's next

You'll get the date and venue in advance in the WhatsApp group. **Bring:** the kit and shoes you train in, a watch (ideally with a chest strap), water, a towel, your phone with the app and questions written down beforehand. For W2 and W3, also your training log and simulation splits.

THE TRAINING APP

01 On Monday, read the whole week, not just today, and lay it out using chapter 2.

02 Before each session, read the full brief, notes included. That's where the important stuff lives: "keep the first run in Z3, no faster".

03 Watch the exercise video at home, not between sets.

04 After the session, log your results and RPE.

EDUCATION LIBRARY

Videos unlock gradually, in the order you need them. Don't binge them. Watch one, try it in your next session and come back to it a week later.

TOPIC	WHEN TO USE IT
Technique for all 8 stations	Before a session with that station. Film yourself and compare.
Running technique and pacing	During Base, and again before the simulation
Strength training for HYROX	Before strength sessions, especially weeks 1–4

TOPIC	WHEN TO USE IT
Mobility and recovery	Rest days and after sessions
Race week and race day	Race phase

PDF GUIDES AND MENTAL PREP

Alongside this guide you'll get the **Warm-up Protocol** and the **Complete Nutrition Guide** (right at the start), **Mobility and Recovery** (ongoing) and **Race Day + Checklists** (for the Race phase). They're reference documents you'll keep coming back to.

HYROX is won with your head and your pacing. Mental prep covers four topics: motivation and discipline, pre-race nerves, visualisation and goals, and the tough moments mid-race. Like what to tell yourself in the fourth set of wall balls when your body wants to stop.

GOLDEN RULE

Can't find something? Ask in the group. Don't go looking for a workaround on YouTube. It may contradict what we're doing.

06 · COMMUNITY AND COMMUNICATION

YOU TRAIN SOLO. YOU'RE NOT ALONE.

The WhatsApp group is where you ask, share and get the push to keep going. It works well when it has rules.

The group holds up to 50 people on the same program. Coaches post daily tips and answer questions. In our experience, the people who are active in the group complete more sessions. When you see others have knocked out Run A at 6 a.m., it's harder to skip yours.

BELONGS THERE

- Completed sessions and a quick comment
- Questions on training, technique and paces
- Technique videos for feedback
- What worked for you and what didn't
- Backing each other up

DOESN'T BELONG

- Ads and other programs
- Politics and arguments
- Comparing who's faster
- Health details you wouldn't share with 50 people
- Advice that goes against the program

HOW TO ASK

"Didn't hit my intervals, is that bad?" isn't something we can answer. Try this instead: "Week 5, Run A, 6 × 800 m. First three on pace, from the fourth 8 s slower, RPE 9. Slept 5 hours, did Strength / HYROX 1 the day before. Cut it short or leave it?"

01 Week and session

02 What the plan said and what actually happened, in numbers

03 RPE, sleep, what you did the day before

04 One specific question

WHEN WE REPLY

Coaches answer **twice a day**. Not instantly, and that's on purpose. We don't want you waiting for a reply before every set. Ask ahead: questions about tomorrow's session go in today.

GROUP OR DIRECT MESSAGE?

SITUATION	WHERE
Training, technique, paces	Group. The answer helps others too.
Pain, injury, health limitations	Direct message to your coach
Longer break for personal reasons	Direct message to your coach
Pace zones keep feeling off	Direct message, with your session data
Admin and payments	Direct message
Acute health problem	Doctor or emergency services (155 / 112). Not WhatsApp.

GOLDEN RULE OF COMMUNICATION

Tell us early. Pain dealt with in week 3 is one tweak to the plan. The same pain ignored until week 8 can cost you the race.

07 · TRAIN SMART

ANYONE CAN TRAIN HARD. FEW TRAIN SMART.

Over 12 weeks you'll get fatigue, DOMS, maybe a cold and a niggle or two. What matters is knowing when to push on, when to back off and when to stop.

SIGN	FATIGUE / DOMS (OK)	PAIN TO DEAL WITH
Where	Spread through the muscle, both sides	Pinpoint, one side, joint or tendon
When	A day or two after training, then fades	During training, or worse each day
After warm-up	Gets better	Stays the same or gets worse
Movement	Normal, just stiff	You change your stride or technique

- **Up to 2/10, gone after warm-up:** train as planned.
- **3–4/10, movement unchanged:** swap the exercise, shorten, lower the intensity and message us.
- **5/10 or more, or it changes how you move:** stop the session and message your coach directly.
- **Same or worse after two days:** that's not DOMS anymore. See a physio.

ILLNESS: THE NECK CHECK

Above the neck (runny nose, blocked nose, scratchy throat): try 10 minutes of easy movement. Feeling better? Carry on easy. Worse? You're done. No intervals. **Below the neck** (fever, chest cough, body aches, chills, stomach bug): no training at all. After a fever, wait at least 1–2 days fever-free without meds, then start easy and message us. Three days off costs you nothing. Training through a fever can cost you three weeks.

MINOR INJURIES

Torn hands from the sled, blisters, a tweaked muscle. Train around it: sore shoulder, do legs and running. Sore ankle, try the SkiErg and upper body. Don't train through pain, and message us so we can adjust the plan. If nothing improves within a week, see a physio or doctor.

SLEEP, STRESS AND WHEN TO BACK OFF

Training doesn't make you stronger. Recovering from it does. Your body doesn't distinguish between stress from intervals and stress from work; it all comes out of the same account. Aim for 7–9 hours of sleep. Under 6 hours two nights running is a reason to back off. Under-fuelling plus heavy training is the fastest route to injury.

- [ ] Morning check (chapter 8) totals 10 or less three days in a row
- [ ] You miss Run A paces twice in a row at normal RPE
- [ ] Heart rate in Z2 clearly higher than usual at the same pace
- [ ] Poor sleep, irritability, no drive to train

Two or more ticked: swap your next hard session for an easy one and message us.

STOP IMMEDIATELY AND SEE A DOCTOR

Chest pain or pressure. Shortness of breath out of proportion to the effort. Racing or irregular heartbeat. Dizziness, fainting, blacking out. Sudden severe headache. Sharp joint pain, a pop, significant swelling. Tingling or numbness in your limbs. Dark urine with severe muscle pain after training. Stop the session immediately and get medical help; in an emergency call 155 or 112.

08 · TRACKING PROGRESS

IF YOU DON'T LOG IT, YOU DON'T KNOW IT.

In 12 weeks you'll forget how your intervals went in week 2. Your log won't. Five minutes after each session, the same way every time.

AFTER EVERY SESSION

- [ ] Week and session (e.g. "W4, Run B")
- [ ] Plan vs. reality: paces, times, weights, reps, average heart rate
- [ ] Session RPE (1–10), 15–30 minutes after finishing
- [ ] One line: what worked, what didn't, what to change next time

RPE	HOW IT FEELS	TYPICALLY
1-2	Barely anything	Mobility, walking
3-4	Easy, could go for ages	Run B, cool-down
5-6	Focused work	Tempo run, technique
7-8	Hard, not much left at the end	Run A, Strength / HYROX 2
9-10	Maximal	Simulation, test, race

MORNING CHECK

Before your coffee, rate **sleep, energy, muscles and mood**, each 1–5 (5 = best). Total 16–20: train as planned. 11–15: train, but keep an eye on how you feel. 10 or less: swap the hard session for an easy one or rest. A resting heart rate 5+ beats above normal is a sign of fatigue or something coming on.

HOW TO SPOT PROGRESS

- **Same pace, lower heart rate** on Run B
- **Same session, lower RPE:** what was an 8 in week 3 is a 6 in week 7
- **The second half of hybrid workouts** holds together
- **Back on your pace within 200 m** after the sled

— **Shorter transitions,** and set 4 looks like set 1

COACH'S TIP

Every Sunday, go through the week's log. Did I get everything done? What went better than last time? What's holding me back? Five minutes that tell you more than a week of scrolling Strava.

YOUR NUMBERS

BASELINE TEST · WEEK 1

DATE AND VENUE

1 KM TIME / 500 M SPLIT

AVERAGE / MAX HR

MID-PROGRAM CHECK · WEEK 6

WHAT IMPROVED

WHAT TO WORK ON

FINAL TEST · WEEK 12

1 KM TIME / 500 M SPLIT

CHANGE VS. BASELINE

RACE GOAL TIME

09 · FAQ

WHAT YOU ASK US MOST.

Can't find your question here? Drop it in the group.

DO I HAVE TO GO TO CLASSES AT FORM FACTORY?

No. They're not included and the program works without them. We recommend them for the kit and the coaching. Count them as a hard day.

CAN I ADD AN EXTRA SESSION?

At most an easy Z1–Z2 run or mobility. No extra intervals, no extra HYROX workouts.

MY PACES FEEL TOO SLOW.

On easy runs, that's the point. But if Run A also feels like RPE 5, send us your data. You may have undercooked the test.

AND IF THEY FEEL TOO FAST?

Check your sleep, stress, the heat and whether you did Run A after a hard day. Still the case after two weeks? Message us and we'll adjust your zones.

MY GYM HAS NO SLED OR SKIERG.

Pick the programming option that matches your kit. In the Performance phase, get to a gym with a sled at least every other week.

I'M A COMPLETE BEGINNER. CAN I DO THIS?

Yes. Your paces are set for you, not for anyone else. Start on 4 days and don't compare yourself.

I MISSED A WHOLE WEEK. SHOULD I CATCH UP?

Never. Message us and we'll tell you how to pick it back up.

IN THE DELOAD I FEEL LIKE I'M LOSING FITNESS.

Almost everyone does. Your body is absorbing the work. Don't add anything.

CAN I DO ANOTHER RACE DURING THE PROGRAM?

Let us know early. We'll build it in as a session and adjust the week before and after.

MY RACE DOESN'T LINE UP WITH THE END OF THE PROGRAM.

Tell us as soon as possible. Depending on the date we'll shift the deload or taper, or add a maintenance week.

DO I NEED A HEART RATE WATCH?

Not essential. You need something that tracks pace and time. HR helps on Run B and for monitoring fatigue.

WHEN WILL I KNOW MY GOAL TIME?

A rough estimate after the baseline test, a sharper one after the week 8 simulation. We fine-tune it in race week.

FINAL WORD

Twelve weeks won't turn you into a different athlete. They're enough to get you to the start line prepared, with a plan, knowing you did everything you could.

STR2G HYROX

PLAN. TRAIN. PERFORM.

Got a question? Drop it in the WhatsApp group. We, your coaches, answer.

STRONGER TOGETHER.